

FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH



BELLTOWER *November 2025*



From the Pastor

As the leaves change color, the harvests are gathered from the fields and our calendars change to the month of November, we are reminded that we enter a season of Thanksgiving. While we may only have one specific day set aside to indulge in the flavors of the season like turkey, stuffing and pumpkin pie, I think we have so many more things to be thankful for. The commercialism of society pushes us into spending money on Christmas decorations and presents well before we have had the opportunity to give thanks.

The idea of giving thanks has been around for a very long time. In Exodus, God told the Israelites to "Celebrate the Festival of Ingathering at the end of the year, when you gather your crops from the field" (23:16). In the United States we began regularly celebrating Thanksgiving during the Civil War, when Abraham Lincoln declared the 4th Thursday of November to be Thanksgiving. He thought this might help bring some unity to the country.

To help remind us as a body of believers and to share in thanksgiving with one another, we will be asking people to share Simple Blessings. As in the past, we ask that you reflect on all the things we have to be thankful for. But dig deeper, think of the small things we might take for granted. Some examples might be the smell of fresh coffee in the morning, a pet who greets you at the end of the day, a smile from the cashier at the gas station, or a phone call from a friend. We will post them on Sunday, November 23, as we celebrate all that we have to be thankful for.

Whatever is good and perfect is a gift coming down to us from God our Father, who created all the lights in the heavens. God never changes or casts a shifting shadow.
~James 1:17~

Stewardship Thoughts from Nikelle

It's a session of thanksgiving.... And stewardship. We give thanks to God for all of the things that God has done, but we also give back to God resources to help build God's kingdom here on earth. A stewardship letter and pledge request will be in your mailbox soon. Please take a few minutes to consider how God may be asking you to contribute to the work of God here at First Pres. Together we can make a difference in our church family, our community, and around the world.

Each Wednesday we join in prayer as a community.

We invite you to join us.

Gracious and Loving God,

We give you thanks for the gifts you give. Help us to be mindful of the ways that you care for us and provide for us. May we remember to be joyful in the little things.

And when we feel overwhelmed, allow us to feel your peace. When we pull away or forget what our focus should be, draw us back into your presence.

Lord, fill us with love and help us to spread your joy to everyone we meet. May we be your hands and feet every day. Amen.

ANNOUNCEMENTS

Our Prayer Chain is now being handled by Susie Smith and Evelyn Thomas. You can contact Susie if you have a request to share and she will email the Prayer Chain. Evelyn will be Susie's backup. If you submit a request to the Prayer Chain it will be held in confidence with only those members and the pastor, until you share on Sunday morning or yourself. If you would like to be on the Prayer Chain let Susie or Evelyn know and you will be added. Thank you to all those who pray for the requests we receive.

From the Office:

ANNUAL REPORT 2025 To all committee/group chairpersons:

Please compose your annual report for 2025. Submissions should be emailed to the office in a Word or like document. We would like to have them all in by December 1, 2025. Thank you for your timely help.

MISSION & WITNESS

Thanks to your generous giving we were able to provide gifts in the amount of \$395 for the new Habitat family, which were given at the Housewarming Shower that we had in partnership with First Baptist, Grace UMC, Immanuel Lutheran, and St. Paul's Lutheran churches.

Your contributions to the Peace and Global Witness Offering for 2025 of \$200 were distributed as: 75% for Presbytery Peace Mission and 25% staying local for Habitat for Humanity. Thank you for your support. **Mission Witness Committee**

NOVEMBER 2025 SCHEDULE OF WORSHIP HELPERS

November 2, 2025 Observing All Saints Day 21st Sunday after Pentecost DST begins Ephesians 1:11-23: Luke 6:20-31
Musician: Carolyn McBride
Elder & Liturgist: Phil Devers
Ushers: Pat Hughes & Nancy Smith
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship: Donut Day
Communion Preparer: Amy & Bill Shaw

November 9, 2025 22nd Sunday after Pentecost
Musician: Anne Badger
Elder & Liturgist: Evelyn Thomas
Ushers:
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship Host:

November 16, 2025 23rd Sunday after Pentecost
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder & Liturgist: Marilyn Hess
Ushers:
A/V: Cathy Anderson & Phil Vella
Fellowship Host: Sheri Hill & Gayle Topping

If you would like to help with our Sunday tasks let Pastor or Lois know which one and they will connect you with that scheduler. Thank you!

November 23, 2025 Christ The King Sunday Celebrating Thanksgiving
Musician: Carolyn McBride
Elder & Liturgist: Lance Schaefer
Ushers:
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship Host: Amy & David Badger

November 30, 2025 1st Sunday of Advent
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder & Liturgist: David Badger
Ushers:
A/V: Angie Montague & Lance Schaefer
Fellowship Host: Evelyn Thomas

November Birthday & Anniversaries

11th Marilyn Hess
Theodore Hoyle
15th Patty Wiley
18th Donna Oster
22nd Jake Pratt
25th Cathy Anderson
27th Toni Vella
30th Robert Wendt
Chuck & Glenna Beckman (A)

November 2025

Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
						1
2 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	3 1:00pm Quilters Work Day in Afternoon 6:00pm Quilters Meeting	4 9:30am Innermission Committee 12:30pm Worship Committee Meeting 3:00pm Mission/Witness Committee 4:00pm Finance & Property Committee	5 5:00pm Christian Education Committee	6 4:00pm Caregiver Support Meeting	7	8
9 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	10 1:00pm PEO Chapter AC Meeting	11	12	13 6:00pm PEO Chapter KM Meeting	14 1:00pm Community Garden Meeting	15
16 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	17 1:00pm Bible Study	18 6:30pm Session Meeting	19 Newsletter Deadline	20 4:00pm Caregiver Support Meeting	21	22
23 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	24	25	26	27 Thanksgiving Day - Office closed	28 Office closed	29
30 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour						



COMMUNITY PRAISE NIGHT
PRESENTS

Thankful Through the Ages

**SUNDAY, NOVEMBER 16, 2025
6:00 PM**

New Life Lutheran Church

STERLING, IL

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SUGGESTED
OFFERING
OF \$5 PER
PERSON
WILL BE
TAKEN

FOR SAUK
VALLEY
AREA
HOMELESS
SHELTERS

OR PAPER
TOWELS,
NAPKINS OR
TOILET PAPER
CAN BE
DONATED AT
THE DOOR

79th Presentation of *Messiah* by George Frideric Handel



A Regional Christmas Season Tradition Since 1945!

**Saturday, November 29, 2025, at 3:00pm
& Sunday, November 30, 2025, at 3:00pm**

at Emmanuel Lutheran Church, 920 Third Avenue, Rockford, Illinois

presented by the

Rockford Choral Union

**Featuring Professional Soloists, Large Regional Chorus,
Chamber Orchestra, Pipe Organ, and Harpsichord,
and Conductor Michael Beert**

No Admission Charge Donations Welcome

<https://rockfordchoralunion.com>

For more info, scan:



Both performances will be livestreamed on our Facebook page:



www.facebook.com/rockfordchoralunion



**First Presbyterian Church of Dixon
Sunday Service: 9:30 a.m.**

Find us on Facebook & YouTube.

www.fpcdixon.com

Pastor: Rev. Nikelle Johnson
Administrative Assistant: Lois Grimm
Custodian: Julie Glenn

Music Director: Kathleen Schaefer
A/V Tech: Carolyn McBride

OUR PURPOSE STATEMENT

As followers of Jesus Christ, we will, by our intentional actions,
seek a deeper relationship with God,
listen for the Spirit's call to mission in our community,
and prayerfully lead others to know the joy of God's love,
and to realize God's purpose for life's journey.

